

BARRIERS TO FRESH FOOD ACCESS

Nutritional Health and Wellness



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Syracuse University[♦], Food Access Healthy Neighborhoods Now! (FAHNN)[♥], and the University of California, Irvine[♣], partnered to understand grocery shopping patterns, food security, barriers to fresh food access, and residents' priorities to overcome these barriers in Syracuse, NY. **This brief summarizes results from the health and wellness answers to our survey conducted October-December 2025.**

What 476 Syracuse-area residents told us about fresh foods and health

THE BIG PICTURE from our respondents: **58% experience low or very low food security**

Among them, **58%** are Black and **52%** have a household income <\$25,000

40% describe their health as fair or poor

78% say fresh, nutritious foods reduce stress

Food security in the last 12 months among our respondents

59% said the food they bought didn't last and they didn't have money to get more

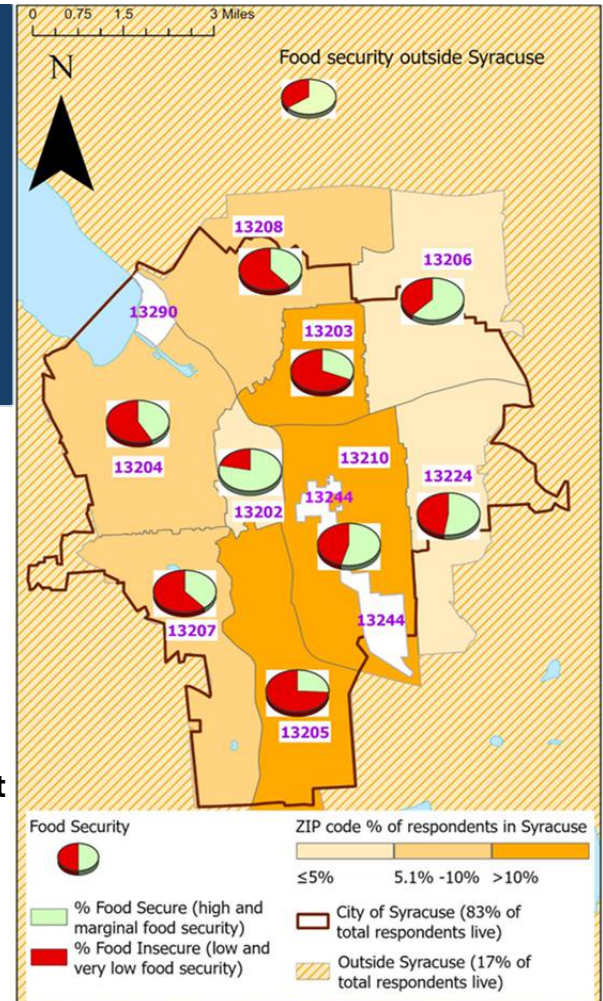
56% couldn't afford to eat balanced meals

38% ate less than they felt they should because they did not have enough money

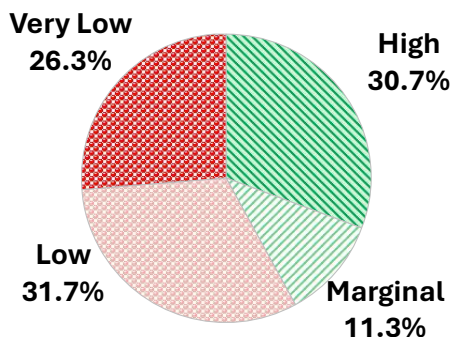
29% were hungry but didn't eat because there wasn't enough money for food

Mental health among our respondents

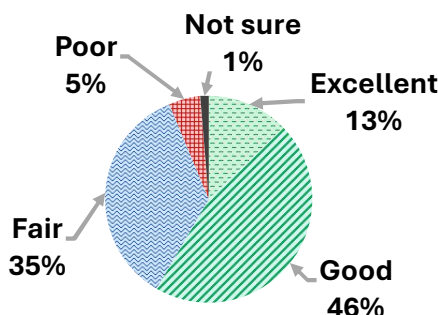
35% do not have adequate access to mental health



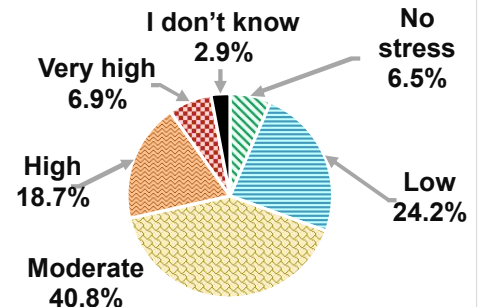
Food security



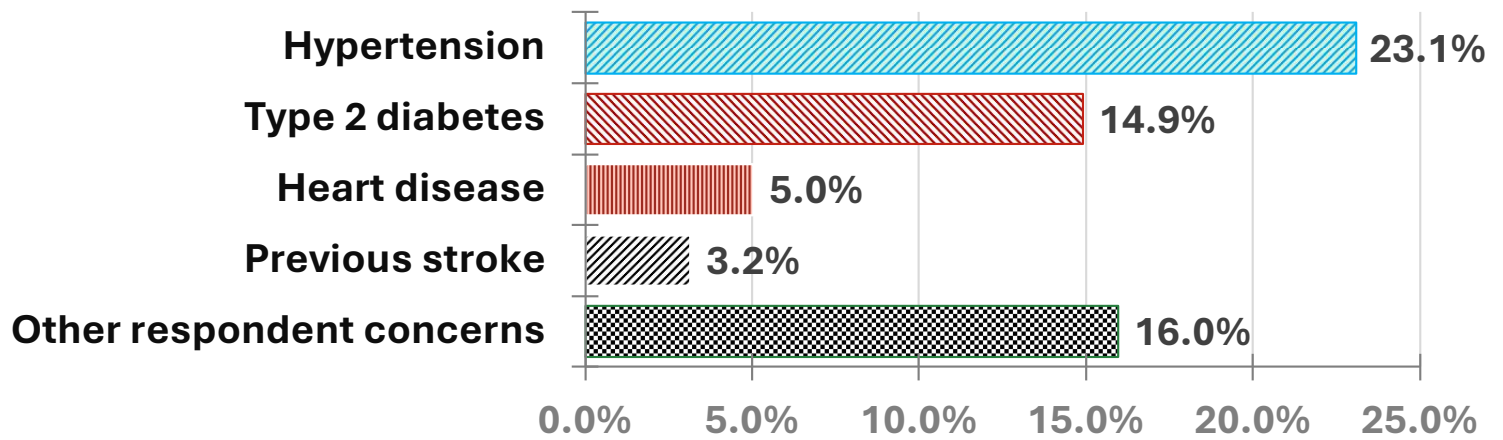
Self-described health



Self-described stress

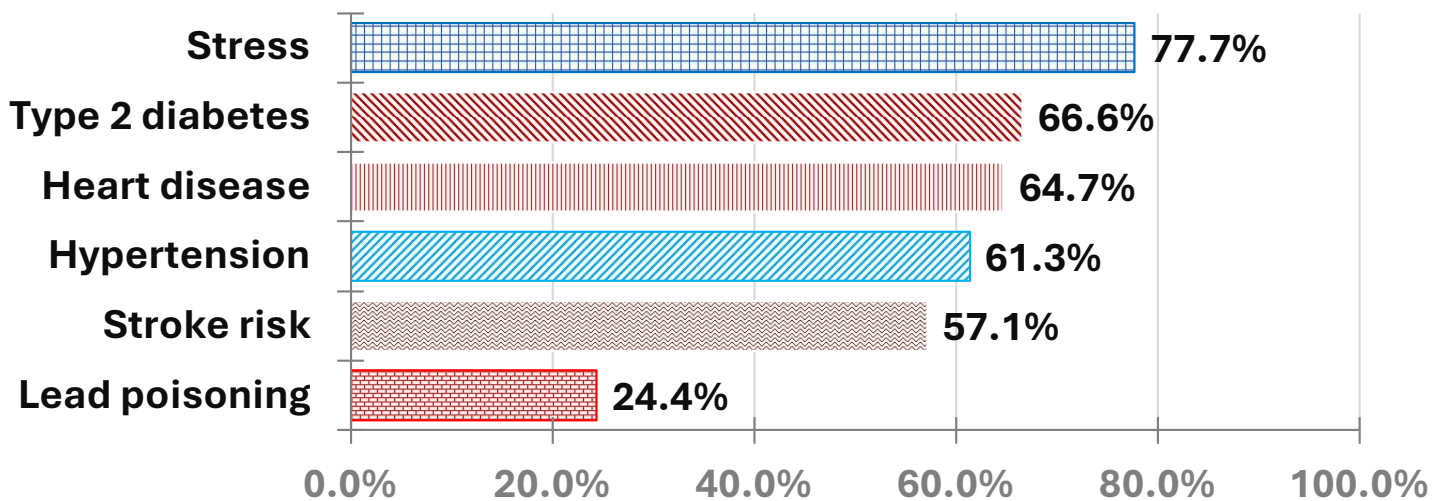


Most common diet-related issues



Other respondent concerns: *being overweight, nutrient deficiency, and high cholesterol.*

Beliefs about how fresh food can help address the following



Our respondents:

68.5% Female
46.9% Black (**33.8%** White)
5.5% Hispanic
43.5% High school education or less
47.7% Employed
32.4% 62 years or older

Their household:

38.4% Income <\$25,000
33.2% Receive SNAP/food stamps
26.1% No weekly vehicle access
37.2% Children in household
35.3% Seniors in household
22.7% Has person(s) with a disability

476

valid survey
responses

421

in-person
respondents

55

online
respondents

\$25

gift card for each
participant